

Dead of Winter

Errata

E: Loretta Clay's ability should read (4+) instead of (4) (FAQ P.2).

E: Old Divisions crossroads card's trigger should read "If a survivor the player controls is at the colony and there is at least 1 helpless survivor at the colony" ([link](#)).

E: When performing an attract, you can choose to attract fewer than 2 zombies, even 0 ([link1](#), [link2](#)).

E: Playing without adding a betrayal secret objective on setup is allowed but the game will be easier, which might be offset by using the hardcore variant ([link](#)).

Rules and Rulings

--General--

Question: What's the purpose of the group leader?

Answer: To select the 1st player, used for some objectives, and thematic purpose ([link](#)).

Q: If the 1st player doesn't participate in a group decision, who would break a tie?

A: Still the 1st player (P.4, [link](#)).

Q: Why is the 1st player token passed to the right?

A: To reduce downtime, and reduce pressure for the 1st player to handle crisis and cleanup ([link](#)).

Q: Are the number of cards in decks and hands public information?

A: Yes, and the number of cards a player adds to crises as well ([link](#)).

Q: Are card content in hand hidden from other players?

A: Yes ([link](#)).

Q: What happens when a Location runs out of cards?

A: Nothing ([link](#)).

Q: Can I refuse healing effects from another player?

A: Not if it's a card effect, since effects must be followed ([link1](#), [link2](#)). Refusing healing may also prevent that player from completing their objective ([link](#)).

Q: Can I combine "Kill X zombies instead of 1" effects?

A: No, they replace a survivor's normal attack, so only 1 effect can be used per attack ([link](#)).

Q: Can I combine effects that trigger when performing an attack with effects that allow me to attack without using the attack action?

A: Yes. For example, **FN SLP Shotgun** can combine with **Switchblade** so that you can spend 1 action die to attack, kill 2 zombies, and a noise token if possible; or **Mike Cho** with **Baseball Bat** can attack and kill 2 zombies without rolling for exposure. ([link](#))

Q: Does the game end right away if morale drops to 0?

A: Depends. The game would end immediately unless morale drops to 0 due to survivors dying during a location overrun, in which case the morale check would happen after specific steps as follows: add zombies to the colony > check morale > add zombies to all non-colony locations in location order > check morale > resolve noise tokens one at a time from all locations in location order > check morale. (P.14, FAQ P.4, [link](#))

Q: Can I combine effects that trigger when performing a search?

A: Yes. For example, **Alexis Grey** can use **Library Blueprints** to look at and keep 3 cards with an action die or use **Flashlight** when making noise to look at 5 cards and keep 2. ([link](#))

Q: Are unused cards that are returned to the box on setup count as "removed from the game" for effects?

A: No ([link](#)).

--Objectives--

----Main Objectives----

Q: How do I add cards to the main objective?

A: Place the cards you are adding to the main objective face up under the main objective card (or next to it, if you prefer). You can only add cards to the main objective that are required. You can add as many cards to the main objective as you like during your turn unless the main objective says differently. (FAQ P.3)

Q: Does the game end immediately when the main objective is completed?

A: No, you keep playing until reaching step 5 "Check main objective" of the colony phase ([link](#)).

Q: Can I place starter cards under the main objective if it says "Players may place non-starter cards" only?

A: No ([link1](#), [link2](#)).

Q: What does "survive X rounds" mean?

A: After X rounds, if morale isn't 0, the game ends and the main objective is completed ([link](#)).

Q: For **Stockpile**, can I add multiple cards on a turn?

A: Yes, as many as you want ([link](#)).

Q: For **We Need More Samples**, should I roll for sample or exposure first after killing a zombie?

A: You roll for sample first ([link](#)).

Q: For **We Need More Samples**, does kills from effects count?

A: Anything that says "kill X zombies" and not "remove X zombies" counts ([link](#)).

Q: For **We Need More Samples**, can I choose not to roll for sample?

A: No, it's automatic ([link](#)).

Q: For **Raiding Party**, if I choose option 2 when resolving the crossroads card **Bev Russell**, does that count towards the objective?

A: Yes ([link](#)).

----**Secret Objectives**----

Q: Can I talk about my secret objective to other players?

A: Yes, and you can also refuse to, or lie. You must not show anyone your object card, say its name, read its text aloud, tell or hint at details too specific in it. (P.6, [link1](#), [link2](#), [link3](#))

Q: Why should I hide my non-betrayal secret objective?

A: Because the betrayer can prevent you from completing it, forcing you to delay finishing the game and help reduce morale to 0 ([link](#)). It could also make other players feel suspicious of you if you propose an idea that you think benefits the colony but also benefits your objective. And there might be times when 2 secret objectives directly clash. ([link](#))

Q: If an objective requires 3 cards in hand and another requires 2, do I need 3 or 5 cards to fulfill both of them?

A: 3. A card can count for multiple objectives. ([link](#))

Q: Does **Hunger** require 3 food cards or 3 food tokens?

A: Cards, like all other objectives ([link](#)).

Q: Is **Hoarder** fulfilled if I'm tie for having most cards in hand?

A: No ([link](#)).

--**Rolling Action Dice**--

Q: If survivors would die due to frostbite at the start of my turn, do I still receive action dice for them?

A: Yes ([link](#))

--**Actions**--

----**Adding a Card to the Crisis**----

Q: Can I request an equip item card, immediately equip it, use its effect, then add it to the crisis in 1 turn?

A: Yes ([link](#)).

----**Attracting**----

Q: Can I attract 2 zombies from different locations?

A: 1 location per attract action only ([link](#)).

Q: When attracting zombies from the colony, can they come from difference entrances?

A: Yes ([link](#)).

Q: When attracting zombies to the colony, must I place them in entrance 1, then 2 etc. like when adding zombies in the colony phase?

A: No, you can place them however you want ([link](#)).

Q: When attracting zombies to the colony, must I place them in 1 entrance?

A: No, you can split them ([link](#)).

Q: Can I attract zombies from 1 colony entrance to another?

A: No, only from another Location to the survivor's Location ([link](#)).

Q: Can I attract zombies to a location with not enough spaces available for zombies?

A: No, zombies can only be attracted and placed in empty spots. They do not cause an area to become overrun nor do they break down barricades. (FAQ P.3)

----**Handing Off**----

Q: Can I force a survivor to receive an item?

A: No, handing off is consensual ([link](#)).

----**Requesting**----

Q: Can I request a card to use for an ability?

A: Yes. Requested cards must be played immediately, either for their ability, or towards an ability that requires the item (FAQ P.3). This is because request is intrinsically a nested action ([link](#)). This overrides a previous ruling that said you can't request cards to be used towards an ability ([link](#)).

Q: Can I request a card from a player having no survivors in the same location as any of my survivors?

A: Yes, this way players can more easily help each other ([link1](#), [link2](#)).

Q: Can I place a requested card on the main objective?

A: No. You may only play the card for its effect or equip it to a survivor you control. ([link](#))

----**Searching**----

Q: Can I do multiple searches without making noise?

A: Yes, by spending one action die per search ([link](#)).

Q: Do I reveal cards to other players when searching?

A: No ([link](#)).

----**Spending Food Tokens**----

Q: Can I spend food tokens to increase my action die result by one if I have no unused action dice left?

A: No. You may also not spend a food token to increase a die if the die is at 6. (FAQ P.3)

--**Adding Zombies**--

Q: If zombies are placed in the Resolve Crisis step, should I still start placing zombies from entrance 1 in the Adding Zombies step?

A: Yes, you start over at 1 each time you place zombies ([link](#)).

Q: If a zombie can't be placed due to a barricade, is the next zombie placed on the space the destroyed barricade left behind?

A: No, it is placed on the next entrance regardless of the previous zombie being placed or not ([link](#)).

Q: When do I add and remove survivors that are killed and gained when adding zombies?

A: A simple breakdown of the Adding Zombie effect: add zombies to the colony > check morale > add zombies to all non-colony locations in location order > check morale > resolve noise tokens one at a time from all locations in location order > check morale.

If a player's last remaining survivor would be killed (or otherwise lost), that player immediately removes from the game all cards in her hand, draws a new survivor card, adds it to the game, and makes that survivor her new group leader. This process will interrupt any of the Adding Zombie steps above. If an exiled player loses their last survivor, they choose a new non-colony location to place their new survivor. They may choose to place it at a location that has not had zombies added yet. (FAQ P.4)

--Paying Food--

Q: How do starvation tokens work?

A: Follow the instructions in the rulebook to the letter. An example:

Round 1: the colony has 5 food and 13 survivors, so not enough food; add 1 starvation token and lose 1 morale.

Round 2: the colony has 8 food and 15 survivors, so enough food; lose 8 food to feed the colony.

Round 3: the colony has 2 food and 15 survivors, so not enough food; add 1 starvation token and lose 2 morale (one for each of the 2 starvation tokens). (FAQ P.4)

Q: Can starvation tokens be removed?

A: Only through some effects (FAQ P.4).

Q: If there're enough food tokens in the supply to feed the survivors, can the players choose not to feed?

A: No (P.12, [link](#)).

--Resolving Crisis--

Q: If a food card can add multiple food tokens to the food supply, does it count as 1 or multiple cards when resolving crises?

A: Only 1; the crises require a number of cards, not value (P.11).

--Exile--

Q: Can the person chosen to be voted cast a vote?

A: Yes ([link](#)).

Q: What if there aren't enough empty spots for exiled survivors?

A: For each exiled survivor without an empty spot, the exiled player moves a non-exiled survivor at a non-colony location back to the colony, then move the exiled survivor there. This does not count as a move. They do not roll for exposure (FAQ P.3). This overrides a previous ruling that said you do roll for exposure ([link](#)).

Q: Do helpless survivors brought in by the exiled player get exiled with them?

A: No ([link](#)).

Q: Must I reveal my secret objective after being exiled?

A: Only if you're not the betrayer. This is written not in the rulebook but on the Exiled Secret Objective cards themselves. ([link](#))

Q: Can an exiled player request cards or give cards to a player requesting cards?

A: Yes (FAQ P.3).

Q: Can an exiled player add cards to the main objective?

A: Yes (FAQ P.3).

Q: Can an exiled player add food tokens to the colony by playing a food card?

A: Yes (FAQ P.4). This overrides a previous ruling that said they can't ([link](#)).

Q: Can an exiled player call to exile another player?

A: Yes (FAQ P.4).

Q: Can an exiled player perform a hand off action with a non-exiled player?

A: Yes ([link](#)).

Q: Can exiled survivors move back to the colony?

A: No ([link1](#), [link2](#)).

--Exposure--

Q: Are frostbite wounds considered wounds when determining if a survivor is killed by wounds and for treating wounds?

A: Yes, frostbite wounds are considered wounds for all effects (P.11, [link](#)).

Q: Do bite effects spread to helpless survivors?

A: No ([link](#)).

Q: If a bite effect spreads to the last survivor in the colony that's also the last remaining survivor of a player and that survivor fails the exposure roll, will the bite effect spread to the newly drawn survivor placed in the colony?

A: No, the effect is over as soon as the last survivor at the colony dies, then the new survivor comes in ([link](#)).

--Survivor--

----General----

Q: Is there a limit to the number of survivors a player can have?

A: No ([link](#)).

Q: Are abilities that kill zombies considered attacks?

A: Unless specified so, no, but they count as killing zombies for effects e.g. secret objectives ([link](#)).

Q: Can a survivor use other survivors' cards?

A: Unless specified so, no ([link](#)).

Q: If a survivor is added to the game in my turn, can I immediately perform actions with that survivor?

A: Yes, but note that the survivor won't give an action die until your next player turn phase (P.14, [link](#)).

Q: If a survivor's card is removed from the game but the standee isn't, can I still control that survivor?

A: No ([link](#)).

Q: Can I use a once per round ability out of my turn?

A: No, only on your turn ([link](#)).

Q: If my survivor has 1 frostbite wound token and 1 wound token before my turn, when would they die?

A: At the start of your player turn, right after the roll action dice effect in the player turns phase ([link](#)).

----Specific----

Q: How many dice must I spend to use **Edward White's** ability?

A: 1 to attack just like normal, and 1 to use his ability to kill 2 more zombies and skip all 3 exposure rolls (FAQ P.2). This overrides a previous ruling that said you may spend a die to use the ability without attacking normally first, and that it counts as an attack ([link](#)).

Q: Can I use any card with a medicine symbol to use **Edward White's** ability?

A: Yes (FAQ P.2).

Q: When does **John Price's** ability take effect?

A: After he has completed a move to a non-colony location, and the abilities he copies go away once it has completed a move to a new location. For example, he must roll for exposure when moving to a location where Rod Miller is at but doesn't do so when moving away from it. (FAQ P.1)

Q: Can **John Price** mimic any combination of abilities at the location he is at?

A: Yes. For example, if he's at the hospital with Janet Taylor and Jenny Clark, he can search and look at 5 cards total and keep 2 cards in 1 action. (FAQ P.1, P.2)

Q: Can **John Price** use a survivor's once per round ability that has already been used this round?

A: Yes, but he also may only perform that action once per round (FAQ P.2).

Q: What happens when **John Price** use a survivor's ability that mentions that survivor's name?

A: It would target John himself ([link](#)). For example, when he uses Forest Plum's ability, he removes himself, not Forest, from the game (FAQ P.2). This overrides a previous ruling that said he would target Forest ([link](#)).

Q: What happens if, while having 3 wounds, **John Price** no longer shares a location with Buddy Davis?

A: He dies once the move is completed (FAQ P.2).

--Crossroads Cards--

----General----

Q: If a survivor dies while moving, does a crossroads card with a movement trigger still trigger?

A: No, a player needs to finish the action that triggers a crossroads card before it is triggered (FAQ P.2). If the trigger is movement, finish the movement and resolve the exposure roll's effect before resolving the card ([link1](#), [link2](#)).

Q: Should the entire crossroads card, including the outcome of each option, be read aloud?

A: Yes (P.12). There are reasons why you should do so: ([link1](#), [link2](#))

- Crossroads cards represent a fork in the path of a survivor's life, and while the immediate outcome of a decision is usually easily visualized, the ripples and far-reaching consequences later are not.
- Not reading their outcomes gives an advantage to experienced players.
- Many cards add uncertainty through dice rolls or card draws, and you should decide whether the risk is worth the reward.
- Certain options in some situations can make you lose the game immediately.

Q: If part of the Crossroads card effect says, "if able" and that part can't be done, does that affect other parts of the card?

A: Unless "if able" is part of the trigger, the other parts still need to be carried out, and players still have all options to choose from if they can fulfill their conditions ([link](#)).

Q: Can I choose an option that can't be fully carried out?

A: No (P.12, [link](#)).

Q: Can I choose an option that requires "all X" if I have none?

A: Yes. For example, when resolving **No Ammo**, you can choose option 2 and "move all action dice from your unused action dice pool" even if you have no dice ([link](#)).

Q: Can any player trigger Crossroads cards?

A: No, the text only applies to the player taking that turn (P.12).

----Specific----

Q: When resolving **Bev Russell**, if I choose option 1, does she count as a survivor when adding zombies?

A: Yes. But if a survivor needs to die due to overrun, Bev can't be targeted because she can't be killed and she doesn't have an influence value. (FAQ P.2, [link](#))

Q: When resolving **Old Divisions**, if I chose the thumbs up option, what happens to the item cards already submitted to the crisis?

A: Remove the cards from the game without revealing them (FAQ P.3).

Q: Who votes when triggering the **Outbreak** crossroads card?

A: Players that currently have a survivor at the colony (FAQ P.3).

Q: Can the player drawing **This Taste Funny** trigger it?

A: The intention is that it's not possible ([link](#)).

Q: Is **Welcome Home** a gun item card when attached?

A: No, it's not an item card ([link](#)).

--Item Cards--

----General----

Q: Do **Outsider** cards or cards with *EVENT* effect count as item cards?

A: Yes, all starter cards and cards in the location decks are item cards; you may keep them in your hand until you want to play them, or request and play them into the crisis (FAQ P.3, [link](#)).

Q: Can a survivor equip 2 of the same items?

A: Yes ([link](#)).

Q: If a card with a once per round ability is used by a survivor that later dies in that same round, it is returned to the player's hand. If the player then equips it to another survivor, can its ability be used in that same round?

A: No, its state isn't reset ([link](#)). Same with handing off a used item to another survivor (P.11).

----Specific----

Q: If I use **Baseball Bat** to kill 2 zombies, must I roll for exposure twice?

A: Yes ([link](#)).

Q: Can I use **Megaphone** to move zombies to a location with no spaces available for zombies?

A: It works the same as the attract action (FAQ P.3). This overrides a previous ruling that said if the location chosen to move the zombies to has no empty space, an overrun will happen ([link](#)).

Q: Does **Switchblade**'s effect replace normal attacks?

A: No, it only changes the required action die, and therefore can be combined with other effects that replace normal attacks ([link](#)).

SPECIAL 2-PLAYER VARIANT:

PRISONER'S DILEMMA

Created by the designer Jon Gilmour and members of BoardGameGeek ([detail](#), [thread](#)).

Follow the 2 player variant rules but on setup, deal each player 1 regular secret objective and 1 betrayal secret objective.

The ways the game can end are:

1) The main objective is completed. Any player who has completed their regular secret objective win, otherwise lose.

2) The morale track reaches 0. If only 1 player has completed their betrayal secret objective, that player win. If either both players or none have completed their betrayal secret objective, all players lose.

My personal suggestions:

1) *When the round track reaches 0, follow the same process as when the morale track reaches 0.*

2) *Don't remove cards with non-co-op symbol.*

3) *Remove all crossroads cards and any other things referencing exiled survivors.*

Dead of Winter: The Long Night

Q: Are improvements replenished when one is built?

A: The designer's original intention is no and the English rulebook follows that, but other versions like Italian or Polish say that new cards must be filled ([link](#)).

Dead of Winter: Warring Colonies

Q: Can I use a survivor's ability after flipping the timer?

A: Abilities that don't depend on player actions can still be used e.g. **Chloe Larousse's** ([link](#)).

Q: On step 4 of combat, what if there's a tie?

A: There would be no wounds to distribute ([link](#)).

Q: In combat, can both colonies lose all survivors?

A: Yes, because dealing wounds is simultaneous ([link](#)).

Q: Can I use bullets to send an enemy survivor at my colony entrance home?

A: No ([link](#)).

Q: How should I resolve the spreading bite effect if 2 survivors have the same influence?

A: If they are from the same colony, the colony leader decides; if not, roll a die ([link](#)).

Q: If my survivor is killed by the bite effect when moving to the enemy colony, does the effect spread to the enemy survivors in that colony?

A: No, only to your team's survivors ([link](#)).